

Price watch

We cover gaming mice, MFDs, tablets and Wi-Fi routers in this month's Price Watch

**Jabra Boost**

Jabra boosts efficiency for office professionals across Asia. Read their press release to find out more: <http://dgit.in/jabraprel>

Dreams on a budget

Agent 001 shares some gyaan on the art of buying a laptop

Agent 001

agent001@tbinkdigit.com

How does one go about purchasing a laptop? It's a question I've been asked many times and apparently, it's a question that still sends most people into a tizzy and much as I enjoy helping people out, maybe it's time you learnt a thing or two about fending for yourself in this tech world. You know the thing they say about teaching a man to fish right?

Ideally I supposed we'd want our tech needs to be fulfilled in a more satisfactory fashion, where we just waltz into a store and walk away with the gadget of our dreams. Why should we sit and worry about CPUs and RAM when all we want is a device to do our bidding? Well, your dreams aren't that far away from realisation, actually. Now I've been testing laptops (among other gadgets) for many a year and finally, after this much time, I think we're finally at a turning point when it comes to laptop power.

Both Intel and AMD have worked really hard on their CPUs and though they've taken a divergent path when it comes to implementation, almost all their CPUs now deliver enough power to ensure that at least your basic computing experience is intact. And by basic we mean that Windows 8 (Windows 7 too, if you prefer it) will run with all its bells and whistles and that your browsing and document editing will function smoothly.

Of course, a bare-bones laptop is not what everyone is looking for, so here are

a set of general guidelines that should help you decide on your own and stand you in good stead for some time yet.

CPU

AMD or Intel is an age old question that for is still a matter of serious debate among enthusiasts the world over. While things may not be plain and simple in the PC world, in the laptop world the advantages and disadvantages are clear as day.



Before we sort that out though, bear in mind that this is the single most important component in your laptop. Laptops are not traditionally meant to be power-

houses, but a good CPU goes a long way in ensuring a more comfortable computing experience, as well as towards future-proofing your device.

Intel: For a bare-bones laptop, anything above Intel's Celeron 1000 series of CPUs (i.e., any CPU launched since 2013) should be enough. From whatever tests I've conducted, one thing's been blindingly obvious, if you're going for a laptop, get one that's powered by Intel's Haswell CPUs (basically the Intel CPUs with a model no. that goes 4xxx). The improvements in battery-life over every other competing CPU is staggering and if you want a portable device, you wouldn't want any other CPU in your laptop. An i7 is simply an indulgence. It's definitely nice to have one, but you'll rarely need anything more than an i5 for most of your needs. Also remember that when it comes to gaming, an i5 + GPU combo is way better than just an i7 CPU.

If you have a tight budget, get a Celeron powered device. If you need

